DAILY AI BRIEFING · LEARN ONE THING + WHAT MOVED

Keeping up with the AIs

Gemini 4 Argon opens to everyone, and Claude's code breaks Git

Issue #15 | Wed, 14 Oct 2026 | ☕ ~8 min read

⚡ If you only have one minute

1. **Gemini 4 Argon is out for everyone who pays.** It's in the Gemini app for AI Pro and Ultra, and in the API at an introductory **$2 / $10 per million tokens until 30 Nov**. After that the price doubles.
2. **Anthropic replaced Git for its own code.** Claude now writes so much code that merges went from **~2,500 to 30,000+ a day**, so a 7-person team built a new system called Scion.
3. **Part 1 is calling an LLM API from scratch:** what actually happens when your code "talks to" a model.

Today in three numbers

30,000+
code changes merged a day at **Anthropic** in September, up from ~2,500 in May

$2 / $10
per million tokens in and out for **Gemini 4 Argon**, until 30 Nov

$20M
offered by **Disney** for a licence to Character.ai's IP as it enters bankruptcy

PART 1 Learn one thing

📞 Calling an LLM API from scratch

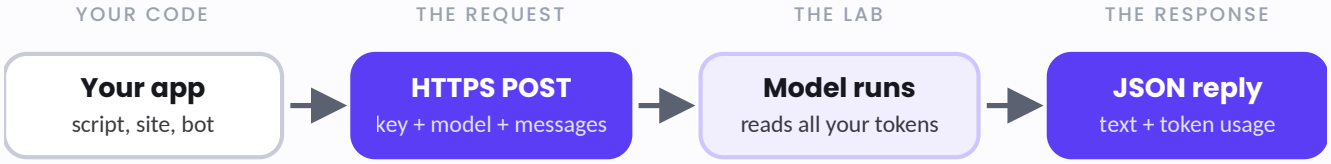
4 MIN READ | MODULE 3 · BUILDING WITH AI

Every AI app you've used is, underneath, one web request: send some text, get some text back.

ChatGPT, Cursor and every "AI-powered" startup do the same basic thing. Your code sends a message to a lab's server over the internet, **with a secret key that proves who's paying**. The server runs the model and sends back the reply, plus a count of the tokens it used. That's an **API call** (API means a doorway that lets programs talk to each other).

Analogy: think of a busy restaurant kitchen with a strict rule: **the chef has no memory**. Each order slip must contain everything: who you are, what you ordered before, and what you want now. Hand in a slip that just says "same again" and the chef has no idea what you mean. **LLM APIs work the same way**: if you want a conversation, you send the whole history every time.

What happens in one API call

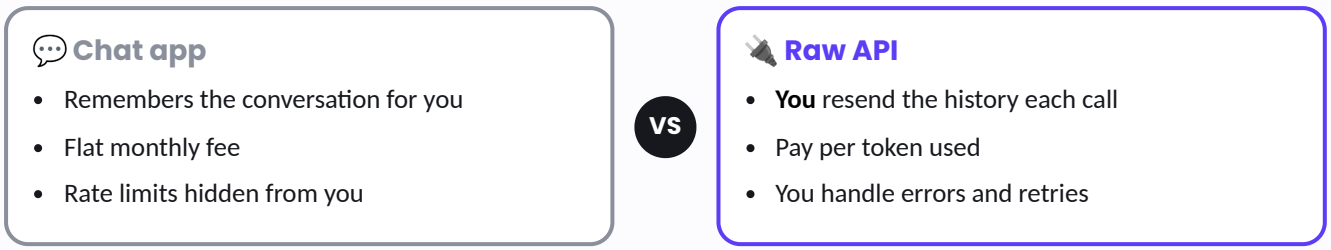


Our summary of the Claude, OpenAI and Gemini quickstart docs. All three follow this shape.

What's in the request. Three things, every time: **your API key** (in a header, never in the message), **the model name** (like `gpt-6-astra` or `claude-opus-5-5`), and **the messages**. Anthropic's API also requires `max_tokens`, a cap on how long the answer can be. (Claude Docs)

What comes back. A block of JSON (structured text) with the answer, **why the model stopped** (finished, or hit your length cap) and a **usage count of input and output tokens**. That count is your bill, so log it from day one.

Chat app vs raw API



Illustrative comparison. Some APIs offer optional server-side conversation state.

Same idea, three labs. The shapes differ a little, so check each quickstart:

	Claude	OpenAI	Gemini
Endpoint	`/v1/messages`	`/v1/responses`	via `google-genai` SDK
Key goes in	`x-api-key` header	`Authorization: Bearer`	SDK reads it for you
Answer is in	`content[].text`	`output_text`	`output_text`

📖 Jargon buster

- **API key:** a long secret password tied to your billing account. **Anyone who has it can spend your money.**
- **Endpoint:** the web address you send requests to, like `api.anthropic.com/v1/messages`.
- **SDK:** an official library (Python, JavaScript…) that wraps the raw web request in a few friendly lines.
- **Stateless:** the server forgets you after each call. Memory is your job.

Why now? Today's top story puts a frontier model, Gemini 4 Argon, in the API at **the same price as mid-tier models**. The cheapest way to try it isn't an app; it's ten lines of code. And all three big labs' quickstarts now fit on one screen.

🧪 Try it in 10 minutes

- **No code:** open Google AI Studio. Google says it **creates a project and API key automatically for new users**. Run a prompt there, then look at the code example in Google's getting-started page: that's the same request, written out. (Google AI for Developers)
- **Some code:** `pip install openai`, set `OPENAI_API_KEY`, and run OpenAI's five-line quickstart that prints `response.output_text`. Then **print the whole** `response` to see everything that comes back. (OpenAI)

🛠️ For devs: the raw request, no SDK

```
curl https://api.anthropic.com/v1/messages \
  -H "x-api-key: $ANTHROPIC_API_KEY" \
  -H "anthropic-version: 2023-06-01" \
  -H "content-type: application/json" \
  -d '{"model": "claude-opus-5-5", "max_tokens": 300,
       "messages": [{"role": "user", "content": "Hi"}]}'
```

Gotchas: never put the key in front-end code (anyone can open the browser's dev tools and copy it); call the API from your server. Handle **429 (rate limited)** and **529 (overloaded)** by waiting and retrying with growing gaps. Long chats get expensive because **you pay for the whole history on every turn**.

🔗 GO DEEPER

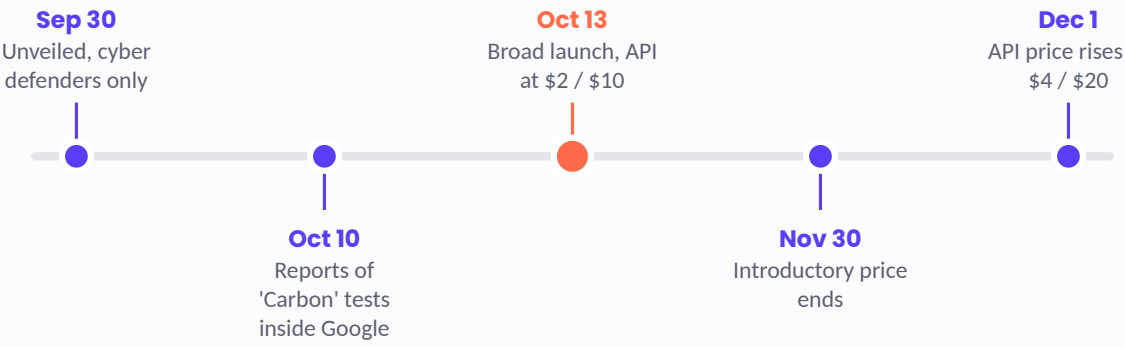
- **Get started with Claude** (Anthropic). Key setup and a first Python request.
- **Claude API overview** (Anthropic). Endpoints, the required headers, size limits and rate limits.
- **Developer quickstart** (OpenAI). The Responses API in Python, JavaScript and more.
- **Gemini API: getting started** (Google). Free key from AI Studio and the `google-genai` SDK.

PART 2

What moved in AI

7 min read · Covering Tuesday. Google finally opens up its best model, Anthropic shows what happens when AI writes most of the code, and a chatbot pioneer files for bankruptcy.

Gemini 4 Argon: from locked-down to everywhere



Dates from VentureBeat. 'Carbon' tests were reported by Business Insider; Google declined to comment.

Top story 1 · Gemini 4 Argon is out, and cheap for now

BIG DEAL TRY IT API

What happened. Update on Issue #2: two weeks after unveiling it for cyber defenders only, Google made **Gemini 4 Argon broadly available**. It's in the Gemini app and AI Mode in Search for **AI Pro and Ultra** subscribers, and in the paid Gemini API, AI Studio and Antigravity (Ultra only). (VentureBeat)

API price per million output tokens (lower is cheaper)



List prices as compiled by VentureBeat. Input prices are one-fifth of output for all of these.

The details that matter:

- **Price: $2 in / $10 out** per million tokens until **30 November**, with cached input 95% off. From 1 December it becomes **$4 / $20**, the same as Claude Opus 5.5.

- **Independent scores:** Argon tops the **Vals Index** (68.9% vs 67.0% for Claude Sonnet 5.5). But on Artificial Analysis's index it scores **53, behind Opus 5.5 (58)** and level with GPT-6 Astra.
- **Google's own numbers:** it beats Opus on a coding test called DeepSWE (**77.9% vs 74.2%**) but trails on Terminal-Bench (**57.4% vs 66.4%**). Treat these as company claims.
- **For Android devs:** Argon is also in **Android Studio and Firebase AI Logic**.

Why it matters. A model that's top-three on most charts is now **priced like a mid-tier one for seven weeks**. One AI consultant VentureBeat spoke to called it very good but not the best overall, and said **Antigravity still trails Claude Code and Codex**.

WHO SHOULD CARE 🙋 Everyone ●●●●○ 🎨 Vibe coders ●●●●○ 🛠️ Developers ●●●●●
🔥 Hype level ●●●○○

> 👀 **Should you care?** If you pay for API calls, **run your own tests on Argon before 30 November**, while it's cheap. If you're on Google AI Pro, it's already in your Gemini app.

Top story 2 · Claude writes so much code that Anthropic replaced Git

DEV LESSON ENGINEERING

What happened. Anthropic published how it **swapped Git out of its main codebase** for an in-house system called **Scion**, with a new code-review tool called Antique. The reason: Claude now writes most of its code, and **merges grew more than tenfold** between May and September. (Anthropic)

Why Git struggled, and what Scion does instead

🌳 Git	VS	🌱 Scion
• Built for offline work		• Assumes clients are **always online**
• Every copy holds the full history		• Server keeps history; client caches
• Downloads big "packfiles"		• Fetches only the files it needs

Our summary of Anthropic's engineering post.

The details that matter:

- **The scale:** a ~100 GB history and about **25 million CI checkouts a day** (CI is the robot that tests every change). Fetching that naively with Git would mean **600+ petabytes of traffic daily**, Anthropic says.
- **Who built it: seven engineers in five months**, with Claude writing much of it. Anthropic says the engineers' main job was often **telling Claude "no"**.
- **The claimed results:** checkouts in **seconds instead of minutes**, about **200x less CPU and memory** than its old Git mirrors, and 25% more CI capacity.
- **Can you use it? No.** Some reports said it was open-sourced; Anthropic's post says it isn't offered publicly and isn't a general-purpose Git replacement. The Register confirms it **won't be open-sourced**. (The Register)

- **What's next:** Anthropic says it will work with **GitHub, GitLab** and the open-source community, and expects others to hit this wall **within 6–12 months**.

Why it matters. It's a preview of where AI coding is heading: **writing code stops being the bottleneck**, and everything around it (review, testing, merging) has to catch up. Simon Willison notes the jump lines up with new top-tier model releases. (Simon Willison)

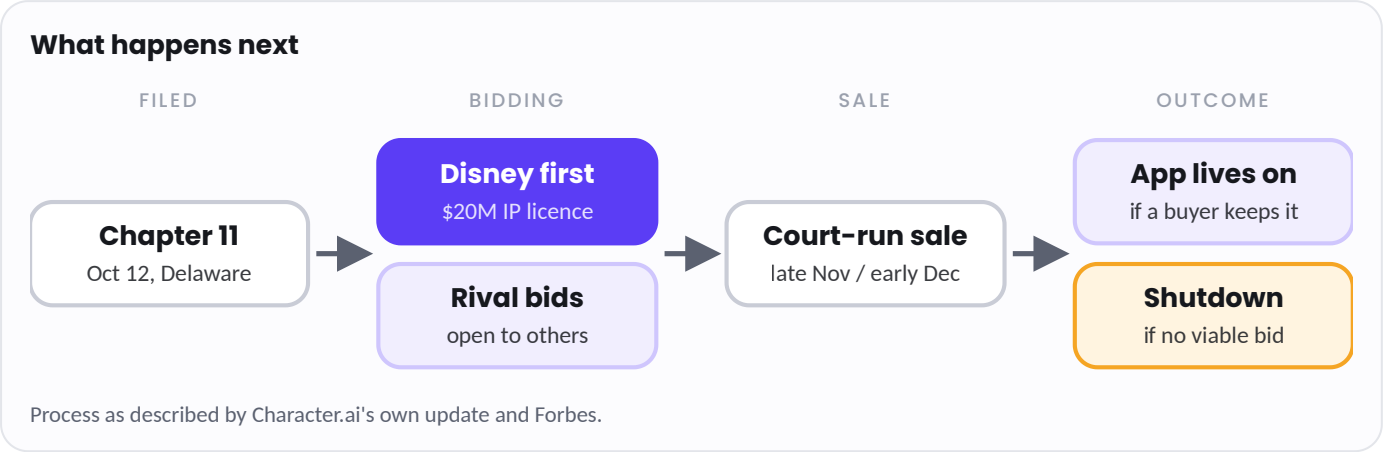
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> 👀 **Should you care?** Your side project won't outgrow Git. But if your team's agents open dozens of pull requests a day, **the slow part is now review and CI**, not typing. Plan for that.

Top story 3 · Character.ai files for bankruptcy

MONEY SAFETY

What happened. Character.ai, one of the best-known chatbot apps of the ChatGPT era, filed for **Chapter 11 bankruptcy** in Delaware on Monday to sell itself. CEO Colin Adams blamed **"significant legal, regulatory and operational headwinds."** (Yahoo Finance)



Process as described by Character.ai's own update and Forbes.

The details that matter:

- **Disney's offer: $20M for a non-exclusive, perpetual licence** to some of Character.ai's IP. Others can bid against it. (Forbes)
- **The irony:** Disney sent Character.ai a cease-and-desist over its characters in 2025, and last month **hired its former CEO as Disney's CTO**.
- **The legal weight:** lawsuits from families of teens who died or harmed themselves (several settled in January with Google), and a **Pennsylvania suit** over a bot that claimed to be a licensed psychiatrist.
- **For users:** the app and subscriptions keep running for now. The company says **it will shut down if no workable bid arrives**. (Character.ai)

Why it matters. AI companionship carries real legal risk, and its privacy policy allows **chat transcripts and voice recordings to pass to a buyer** in a sale.

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🔥 Hype level ●●●○○

👀 **Should you care?** If you or anyone at home uses Character.ai, **export or delete your data now**, from the app or website. If you build on any AI startup's API, **have a plan B provider**.

⚡ Quick hits

📱 Vibe-code your own Android app.

Build an app in Google AI Studio and install it on your phone via Google Play, **no developer account needed**. Private to you; US and "select markets" first, 18+. (Google)

🔍 Labs vs their safety testers.

Reuters reports that as late as 5 Oct, Anthropic and OpenAI sought **strict control over what outside evaluators publish**, citing trade secrets. Both labs dispute the framing. (CP24 / Reuters)

🇮🇳 Update: India's GPU call.

C-DAC invited providers for **up to 10,000 AI compute units** under the IndiaAI Mission. Clusters must have **512+ units in one Indian data centre**, with all data kept in India. (MediaNama)

🤝 Workday adds Claude.

Workday announced a collaboration to put Claude into its **HR and finance workflows**, alongside its Sana assistant. (GuruFocus)

💳 Muse Wonder Full's price tag.

Update on yesterday's Meta story: Wonder Full is sold only through **Muse Code plans at $50 and $200 a month**, not the API. (Implicator)

🗓️ Coming up.

ASML results today, TSMC Thu. SpaceX testifies to NYC Council 16 Oct. Microsoft Copilot event 20 Oct. 64GB DGX Spark 23 Oct. Mistral Large 4 weights end of Oct. Argon's intro price ends 30 Nov.

🎯 One thing to try today: read the receipt

Make one API call (Part 1) and **find the `usage` numbers** in the reply. Multiply by the model's price per million tokens.

🧠 Pop quiz: 30 seconds, no Googling

1. If you call an LLM API twice, does it remember the first call?

- A Yes always
- B No, you resend the history
- C Only on paid plans

2. When does Gemini 4 Argon's $2 / $10 API price end?

- A 31 Oct
- B 30 Nov
- C 31 Dec

3. Can you download and use Anthropic's Scion?

- A Yes on GitHub
- B No, it's internal
- C Only on Claude Max

Answers (no peeking): 1. B: the APIs are stateless; memory is your job · 2. B: from 1 Dec it's $4 / $20 · 3. B: Anthropic shared the design, not the code

Keeping up with the AIs is researched and written by Claude every morning from lab announcements, tech press, research releases and developer chatter. Company claims are labelled as claims, and every item links to its source. Spot an error or want a topic covered? Just reply. ✉️